Integration

ECON 441: Introduction to Mathematical Economics
Lecture 13

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Inverse of Differentiation

Path of population over time:

$$P(t) = 2t^{0.5}$$

Rate of change of population:

$$P'(t) = \frac{dP}{dt} = t^{-0.5}$$

But what if instead we were given $P'(t)$ and were tasked with finding $P(t)$?

Inverse of Differentiation

Note that

$$P'(t) = \frac{dP}{dt} = t^{-0.5}$$

is the derivative of $P(t) = 2t^{0.5}$, but also of $P(t) = 2t^{0.5} + 30$.

Generally, at best, we can find the following from just $P'(t)$:

$$P(t) = 2t^{0.5} + c$$

However, if we have an initial condition such as $P(0) = 50$, we can also find c.

Example: From Marginal Cost to Total Cost

A firm's marginal cost is

$$MC(Q) = 6Q + 2$$

and its fixed cost is 8, so $C(0) = 8$.

Marginal cost is the derivative of total cost: $MC(Q) = C'(Q)$.

Can we recover the total cost function $C(Q)$?

Integration

- Integration is the reverse of differentiation
- If $f(x)$ is the derivative of $F(x)$, we can **integrate** $f(x)$ to find $F(x)$:

$$\frac{d}{dx}F(x) = f(x) \;\Rightarrow\; \int f(x)\,dx = F(x) + c$$

- Rules of integration follow from rules of differentiation

Rules of Integration

Power rule

$$\int x^n \, dx = \frac{1}{n+1} \cdot x^{n+1} + c \quad (n \neq -1)$$

Examples:

$$\int x^3 \, dx, \qquad \int x \, dx, \qquad \int 1 \, dx$$

Rules of Integration

Exponential rule

$$\int e^x \, dx = e^x + c$$

Log rule

$$\int \frac{1}{x} \, dx = \ln x + c \quad (x > 0)$$

Rules of Integration

Integral of a sum

$$\int [f(x) + g(x)]\,dx = \int f(x)\,dx + \int g(x)\,dx$$

Integral of a multiple

$$\int kf(x)\,dx = k\int f(x)\,dx$$

Example:

$$\int (x^2 + 3x + 1)\,dx =$$

Definite Integrals

Definite integral:

$$\int_a^b f(x)\,dx = \Big[F(x)\Big]_a^b = F(b) - F(a)$$

Example:

$$\int_1^3 2x^2\,dx =$$

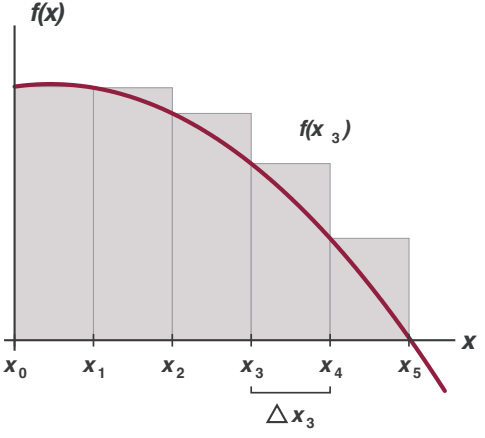
Example: Investment and the Capital Stock

A firm's capital stock $K(t)$ grows through investment: $I(t) = \frac{dK}{dt}$.

Suppose $I(t) = 2t + 5$ and the initial capital stock is $K(0) = 100$.

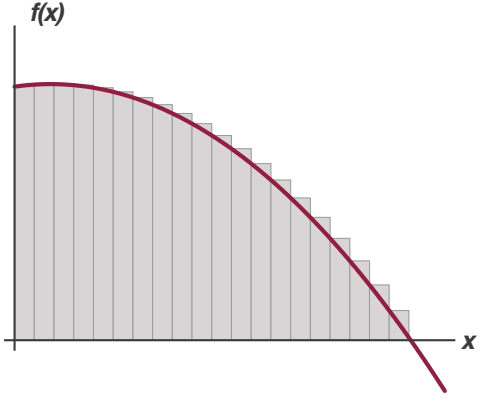
- Find the path of the capital stock $K(t)$.
- How much capital is accumulated between $t = 2$ and $t = 4$?

Area Under the Curve



$$\text{Area} \approx \sum_{i=1}^{n} f(x_i)\,\Delta x_i$$

Area Under the Curve



$$\text{Area} = \lim_{n\to\infty} \sum_{i=1}^{n} f(x_i)\,\Delta x_i$$
$$= \int_{x_1}^{x_n} f(x)\,dx$$

Example: Consumer Surplus

Demand is $p = 48 - Q^2$ and the market price is $p = 12$, so $Q = 6$ units are sold.

Consumer surplus is the area under the demand curve and above the price. The curve is not a straight line, so it is not a triangle: we need the integral.

$$CS = \int_0^6 (48 - Q^2)\, dQ - 12 \times 6 =$$

Homework Questions

- Exercise 14.2: 1 (a), (c), (d)
- Exercise 14.3: 1 (a), (e), 2 (a), (d), 5

Textbook reference: 14.1-14.3

Midterm 2 is next week: review on Monday, exam on Wednesday

A sample exam and a help sheet are posted on the Exams page